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Congress," Jinnah informed Punjabi Muslim and Hindu students in August 1944, though "we do not agree on certain points". "But we should be united against common enemies" just as the League and the Congress came together to vote against the colonial government in the central assembly. "If we must have a separate State," he went on in the same vein, "that will not mean we shall have nothing to do with each other." He was convinced that "both Hindus and Muslims would be happy when Pakistan is established" since it was in their best interest. They would never "allow anybody, whether he is Afghan or Pathan, to dominate us" because "India is for Indians". It would be "foolish of the Hindus, and vice versa", not to come to the defence of Pakistan if were invaded by any outside power.

The calamitous events of 1947 did not alter Jinnah's view of the necessity for good relations with India. He advocated "real friendship" between the two dominions, not the forced reunion that was being predicted. Pakistan had "come to stay" and was "ready to come to an understanding or enter into agreements with Hindustan as two independent, equal, sovereign States." The two dominions "should bury the past and resolve that despite all that has happened, we shall remain friends". "There are many things which we need from each other as neighbours," and "we can help each (other) in diverse ways, morally, materially and politically and thereby raise the prestige and status of both Dominions." A prerequisite was the restoration of law and order so that peace could prevail in the two countries and the minorities in particular could "feel that their life, property and honour are absolutely safe and secure and they will get without question a fair deal from their respective Governments". In March 1948 when asked if Pakistan and India could settle their disputes, Jinnah replied in the affirmative, adding so long as New Delhi "shed the superiority complex" and deals with us "on an equal footing". He had "no doubt" about the "vital importance to Pakistan and India as independent sovereign states to collaborate in a friendly way jointly to defend their frontiers both on land and sea against any aggression". For this to happen, the two countries had to "resolve their differences". "If we can put our house in order internally", Jinnah maintained, "then we may be able to play a very great part externally in all international affairs".

If Jinnah's vision has been lost sight of in Pakistan, his hopes for a real partnership between India and Pakistan remain unrealised. The flow of history has not invalidated Jinnah's vision. He had told his compatriots that the "scrupulous maintenance and enforcement of law and order" was vital



JINNAH'S BATTLE WAS AGAINST CONGRESS MAJORITARIANISM

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for progress. Islam enjoined on every Muslim "to give protection to his neighbours and to the minorities regardless of caste and creed". While warning that Pakistan could not remain a "mere spectator" to the suffering of Muslims in India, the Quaid-e-Azam asked Pakistanis to "make it a matter of our prestige and honour to safeguard the lives of the minority communities and to create a sense of security among them" because "retaliation and violation of law and order will ultimately result in weakening the very foundations of the edifice you have cherished all these years to erect". These words ring truer than ever at a time when Pakistan, whose establishment Jinnah had hailed as a "cyclonic revolution", has spiralled out of control in its single-minded pursuit of strategic parity with India.

In his own assessment of his place in history in which he looked forward to the day Hindus would honour his memory, Jinnah drew an analogy between himself and the first man to appear on the street with an umbrella, only to be laughed and scorned at by the crowd because they had never seen one before. Like other personalities in history who started off on the unbeaten track, he too was carrying an umbrella. "You may laugh at me," he said self-assuredly, but time will soon come when "you will not only understand what the umbrella is but...use it to the advantage of everyone of you." As the state for whose creation he is credited stands dangerously poised at the crossroads of chaos and order amidst new and emergent shifts in regional and international politics, there is an urgent need for Pakistanis and Indians to grasp the meaning of Jinnah's metaphor of the umbrella and rustle up the courage and the conviction to use it to their mutual benefit.

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